

Metrics Checklist

Use this checklist to identify useful metrics for a candidate automation opportunity. The aim is not to collect every possible metric — the aim is to identify enough evidence to understand the pain, test assumptions, and decide what should happen next.

AUTOMATION ASSESSMENT

PROCESS IMPROVEMENT

Map the work. Measure the pain. Automate with purpose.

When & How to Use This Checklist

When to Use

- A process feels painful but the evidence is unclear
- The team needs to understand whether the pain is effort, flow, quality, risk or user impact
- An automation idea needs to be tested with better evidence
- Multiple automation opportunities need to be compared
- Baseline data is needed before improvement or automation
- A team needs to identify what evidence is missing

How to Use

O1

Start with the process map or scenario description

O2

Identify the type of pain being experienced

O3

Review the metric groups: effort, flow, and quality & risk

O4

Capture what is known and mark estimates clearly

O5

Identify missing evidence

O6

Use outputs to support the automation opportunity assessment

 You do not need every metric. Choose the metrics that best explain the pain and value.

1. Process Details

Complete the fields below to establish the context for this assessment.

Process name	[PROCESS NAME]
Date captured	[DATE]
Captured by	[FACILITATOR / TEAM]
Process owner	[PROCESS OWNER]
Business area / team	[TEAM]
Related canvas / scenario	[LINK OR REFERENCE]

2. What Type of Pain Are We Trying to Understand?

Select the main type of pain. More than one may apply.

 Effort Too much manual work, repeated activity or low-value effort	 Flow Delay, waiting, bottlenecks, handoffs or poor visibility
 Quality Errors, rework, missing information or inconsistent outputs	 Risk Compliance, control, security, audit or operational risk
 User Impact Poor experience, frustration, chasing or reduced productivity	 Cost Avoidable cost, duplication or inefficient use of resources

Pain Summary

Describe the pain in plain language below.

3. Effort Metrics

Effort metrics help show how much human work is involved. Use these when the process is manual, repetitive, high-volume or consuming significant staff time.

Metric	Question	Known value / estimate	Source	Confidence	Notes
Volume	How often does this happen?	[VALUE]	[SOURCE]	High / Medium / Low	[NOTES]
Touch time	How much actual human effort is involved per instance?	[VALUE]	[SOURCE]	High / Medium / Low	[NOTES]
Total effort	How much total effort is involved over a period of time?	[VALUE]	[SOURCE]	High / Medium / Low	[NOTES]
Manual effort	Where are people doing repetitive or low-value work?	[VALUE]	[SOURCE]	High / Medium / Low	[NOTES]
People involved	How many people touch the work?	[VALUE]	[SOURCE]	High / Medium / Low	[NOTES]

Effort Notes

 [Capture observations about manual effort, repetition, duplication or low-value work.]

4. Flow Metrics

Flow metrics help show how work moves through the process. Use these when the process is slow, approval-heavy, dependent on handoffs or difficult to track.

Metric	Question	Known value / estimate	Source	Confidence	Notes
Cycle time	How long does the process take from start to finish?	[VALUE]	[SOURCE]	High / Medium / Low	[NOTES]
Wait time	Where does work sit idle between steps?	[VALUE]	[SOURCE]	High / Medium / Low	[NOTES]
Handoffs	Where does work move between people or teams?	[VALUE]	[SOURCE]	High / Medium / Low	[NOTES]
Queue time	How long does work sit before someone starts it?	[VALUE]	[SOURCE]	High / Medium / Low	[NOTES]
Approval time	How long do approvals take?	[VALUE]	[SOURCE]	High / Medium / Low	[NOTES]
Systems used	What tools, forms or platforms are touched across the process?	[VALUE]	[SOURCE]	High / Medium / Low	[NOTES]
Status chasing	How often do people chase updates?	[VALUE]	[SOURCE]	High / Medium / Low	[NOTES]

Flow Notes

 [Capture observations about delay, wait time, handoffs, bottlenecks or poor visibility.]

5. Quality and Risk Metrics

Quality and risk metrics help show where work goes wrong or where the impact of failure is significant. Use these when the process creates errors, rework, inconsistent decisions, risk or poor experience.

Metric	Question	Known value / estimate	Source	Confidence	Notes
Rework / errors	How often does work need to be corrected?	[VALUE]	[SOURCE]	High / Medium / Low	[NOTES]
Missing information	How often is required information incomplete or unclear?	[VALUE]	[SOURCE]	High / Medium / Low	[NOTES]
Exception rate	How often does the process deviate from the standard path?	[VALUE]	[SOURCE]	High / Medium / Low	[NOTES]
Decision inconsistency	How often are decisions unclear, inconsistent or disputed?	[VALUE]	[SOURCE]	High / Medium / Low	[NOTES]
Risk impact	What happens if something goes wrong?	[VALUE]	[SOURCE]	High / Medium / Low	[NOTES]
Control / compliance	Does this affect controls, audit, compliance or security?	[VALUE]	[SOURCE]	High / Medium / Low	[NOTES]
User impact	Who experiences the pain, delay or poor outcome?	[VALUE]	[SOURCE]	High / Medium / Low	[NOTES]

Quality and Risk Notes

 [Capture observations about rework, errors, exceptions, risk, compliance or user impact.]

6. Time Distinction

Use this section if the process feels slow. A slow process may not always involve a lot of work — it may involve a small amount of work and a large amount of waiting.

Type of time	Meaning	Known value / estimate	Notes
Cycle time	Total elapsed time from start to finish	[VALUE]	[NOTES]
Touch time	Actual human effort	[VALUE]	[NOTES]
Wait time	Time sitting idle between steps	[VALUE]	[NOTES]

What does the time profile suggest?

☐ Mostly manual effort / touch time

☐ Mostly waiting / delay

☐ Both effort and waiting

☐ Unclear — more evidence needed

Notes

☐ [What does the distinction between cycle time, touch time and wait time tell us?]

7. Evidence Quality

Capture how reliable the available evidence is. Be honest about where you are relying on assumptions or estimates rather than hard data.

Evidence type	Available?	Confidence	Notes
System data	Yes / No / Partial	High / Medium / Low	[NOTES]
Reports or dashboards	Yes / No / Partial	High / Medium / Low	[NOTES]
Ticket or workflow data	Yes / No / Partial	High / Medium / Low	[NOTES]
Spreadsheet or tracker data	Yes / No / Partial	High / Medium / Low	[NOTES]
Stakeholder estimates	Yes / No / Partial	High / Medium / Low	[NOTES]
Observations / interviews	Yes / No / Partial	High / Medium / Low	[NOTES]
User feedback	Yes / No / Partial	High / Medium / Low	[NOTES]

Evidence Notes

 [Where is the evidence strong? Where are we relying on assumptions or estimates?]

8. Missing Metrics

Capture what still needs to be gathered or validated. Examples include: request volume, average cycle time, average touch time, wait time between steps, approval delay, rework rate, exception rate, number of handoffs, number of systems used, status chasing frequency, risk or control impact, user impact.

Missing metric / evidence	Why it matters	Possible source	Owner	Due date
[MISSING METRIC]	[WHY IT MATTERS]	[SOURCE]	[OWNER]	[DATE]
[MISSING METRIC]	[WHY IT MATTERS]	[SOURCE]	[OWNER]	[DATE]
[MISSING METRIC]	[WHY IT MATTERS]	[SOURCE]	[OWNER]	[DATE]

9. Metric Summary

Summarise the most useful metrics for this opportunity and what they suggest.

Effort

Most useful metrics: [METRICS]

What they suggest: [WHAT DOES THIS TELL US?]

Flow

Most useful metrics: [METRICS]

What they suggest: [WHAT DOES THIS TELL US?]

Quality / Risk

Most useful metrics: [METRICS]

What they suggest: [WHAT DOES THIS TELL US?]

User Impact

Most useful metrics: [METRICS]

What they suggest: [WHAT DOES THIS TELL US?]

Main Evidence-Based Insight

[What is the main thing the evidence tells us about this process?]

10. Implications for Automation

Use the metrics to consider what kind of response may be appropriate.

Evidence pattern	What it may suggest	Notes
High volume + high manual effort	Automation may reduce effort	[NOTES]
Long cycle time + low touch time	Workflow, routing or approval improvements may help	[NOTES]
High rework or missing information	Improve intake, validation or rules first	[NOTES]
High exceptions	Automate standard path only or redesign process first	[NOTES]
Many handoffs	Simplify flow, clarify ownership or improve visibility	[NOTES]
High risk impact	Prioritise control, consistency and governance	[NOTES]
Low volume + low impact	May not be worth prioritising	[NOTES]

Likely Response

Select the likely response based on the evidence:

☐ Automation is likely to help

☐ Process improvement is needed first

☐ Automation and improvement may both be needed

☐ More evidence is needed

☐ This does not appear to be a priority

Notes

☐ [Explain the likely response and why.]

11. Metric-Based Recommendation

Use this section to summarise the recommendation based on all evidence gathered.

What pain are the metrics showing?	[RESPONSE]
Which metrics matter most?	[RESPONSE]
What evidence is missing?	[RESPONSE]
What does this suggest for automation?	[RESPONSE]
What should happen next?	[RESPONSE]

Recommendation

 [Summarise the metric-based recommendation.]

Final Reminder

Do not collect metrics for the sake of it. Use metrics to answer three practical questions:

1. Where is the pain?

Identify the area — effort, flow, quality, risk or user impact.

2. How significant is it?

Quantify the scale, frequency and impact of the problem.

3. What response will help?

Determine whether automation, improvement, or more evidence is needed.

You do not need every metric — just the ones that help explain the pain and value.